

Homepage Discovery Map — status (short)

For the client. Full detail: [Homepage_Map_Status.md](#).

This is a **prototype**, not the live homepage. Data is sample. There is no booking, CMS, or destination pages yet.

In one sentence

The **recommendation funnel** works. The **map surface in the brief** does not — Google Maps cannot deliver it.

What we achieved (and the limit)

Done	Constraint
Four levels: country → city → attraction → products	Sample catalog (6 countries), not live inventory
Preference chips re-rank pins and the list; we never hide destinations	City copy still uses country text; not preference-specific per city
Match labels, reason chips, trade-offs	Editorial sample copy, not live product facts
Prices from city level; full facts and CTA at attraction level	Hardcoded numbers, not live prices
Caps: 8 cities / 4 attractions / 3 products	We always show the cap; crowded labels are not dropped for readability
List under the map; empty photo slots; preference not in the URL	List is not crawlable; /destinations/... pages do not exist
Flat Google map + photorealistic 3D toggle	3D is Google's tiles, not a RosoTravel globe. Google logo must stay

What we have not achieved

Google Maps cannot do these (not a coding gap — the engine cannot honour the brief):

- Natural Earth world map
- Own geometry, RosoTravel styling, **no Google branding**
- Quiet city diagram (dotted field, no street map)
- Globe in the **same** look as the flat map
- Homepage that is **not** a Google wayfinding map

To get those, we need a **custom map**, not a Google setting.

Not built yet (can do on the real site):

- Crawlable list and real destination pages
 - Poster / first paint, map-error fallback
 - How We Do It as one homepage block
 - Attraction clusters, pin collision, live reviews, working **Check dates**
 - Real photography and live catalog
-

Decision

Keep **Google Maps** → rewrite the brief (Natural Earth, no branding, city diagram, matching globe).

Keep the **brief** → Google stays a comparison. The homepage map must be a custom canvas.

The long note has the item-by-item tables.